

James Tabron

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GRC Engineering Leader | AI-Driven Compliance Automation | Former Twilio Director

I am a CISSP-certified GRC engineering leader who uniquely combines six years of GRC experience across multiple verticals with four and a half years of software engineering leadership at Twilio. I have built and scaled security and compliance programs (including SOC 2 and ISO 27001), designing evidence workflows and control testing processes that reduced audit friction and accelerated readiness. I am now actively applying that deep GRC expertise to build AI-driven compliance automation that decomposes controls into actionable units and translates them into repeatable workflows. I am passionate about modernizing cybersecurity by implementing policy as code, embedding controls into CI/CD pipelines, and enabling continuous compliance through automation, and reproducible engineering practices.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS: AI-POWERED GRC AUTOMATION

AI Powered IAM Access Governance Agent

02/2026 - Present

Maps to SOC2 Common Criteria: (CC6.1, CC6.2, CC6.3)

Github: github.com/jtabron1/AI-Powered-IAM-Access-Review-Agent

- Event-driven architecture using Supabase webhooks to trigger real-time IAM synchronization with employee database as the authoritative source of truth
- Autonomous remediation of IAM discrepancies including user provisioning, policy updates, and access revocation for terminated employees
- Preventative controls via CloudTrail and EventBridge to detect and block unauthorized direct IAM modifications with auto-revert capability
- Impact: Eliminates manual IAM access reviews by continuously enforcing least-privilege access and maintaining audit-ready compliance posture

AI Powered AWS Risk Assessment Agent

10/2025 - Present

Maps to SOC2 Common Criteria: (CC3.2, CC7.1, CC7.2)

Github: github.com/jtabron1/AI-Powered-AWS-Risk-Assessment-Agent

- Scheduled Security Hub findings analysis with GPT-4.1 and structured prompt engineering
- Generates executive risk reports translating technical findings into business impact
- Automated data pipeline: S3 > JSON extraction > AI analysis > HTML formatting > Email delivery
- Impact: Significantly reduces monthly and annual risk assessment time while delivering actionable insights from large-scale data analysis

AI Powered Pull Request Compliance Monitoring Agent

10/2025 - Present

Maps to SOC2 Common Criteria (CC8.1)

Github: github.com/jtabron1/AI-Powered-Pull-Request-Compliance-Agent

- Real-time GitHub webhook monitoring for pull request events
- Dual API integration: fetches comments and formal reviews, validates peer approval
- Automated violation detection, logging (Google Sheets), and multi-stakeholder notification
- Impact: 100% change management evidence coverage and real-time notification of non-compliance

WORK EXPERIENCE

Director of GRC Engineering

12/2025 - Present

Aquia

- Architected and deployed a serverless AWS data warehouse (Step Functions, Glue, S3, Athena, Redshift) with an automated, PII-safe ETL pipeline processing **282K** nightly records from DynamoDB, enabling self-service analytics for a state government platform
- Designed an event-driven serverless security control plane (Step Functions, EventBridge, OPA/Rego policies) to continuously validate app configs against JSON baselines for NIST 800-53 Rev. 5 compliance, enforcing cross-account auto-remediation under a **<15-minute** SLA.
- Led a team of GRC engineers responsible for designing, building, and operating continuous Authority to Operate (cATO) solutions for federal agencies in cloud-native environments.
- Defined initial production release criteria and quality gates for infrastructure and application deployments, establishing a repeatable governance process aligned with federal compliance requirements.

Director, Software Engineering

03/2022 - 04/2025

Twilio

- Directed technical strategy for a **\$78 million** marketing automation product portfolio, improving system security, performance, and operational efficiency, enabling **44.4 billion** annual transactions and a **53%** YoY growth in revenue.
- Led modernization of a distributed, event-driven microservices architecture on AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB, Kinesis, API Gateway, S3) deployed across multiple Availability Zones, doubling traffic capacity while reducing compute costs by \$10M+ through serverless optimization and Terraform-managed infrastructure.
- Managed and developed a high-performing remote engineering organization of 33 full-stack engineers and 5 engineering managers, achieving an average annual retention rate of **95%**.
- Increased program velocity **23%** with flat headcount by aligning teams to measurable outcomes, tightening ownership, and instituting bi-weekly management reviews on standardized sprint metrics.

Senior Manager, Software Engineering

11/2020 - 03/2022

Twilio

- Led day-to-day operations of a **\$20 million** ARR on-premise email platform, improving reliability while supporting high-throughput campaign delivery.
- Executed a comprehensive operating system upgrade across the server fleet, achieving **zero downtime** and enhancing security posture by remediating **100%** of all critical vulnerabilities ahead of schedule.
- Collaborated with Legal to embed a security and privacy risk assessment in the engineering blueprint workflow, enabling self-service risk identification ahead of formal review.
- Drove the design and execution of Twilio's first annual Disaster Recovery test for its Email Marketing platform, improving system availability through validated failover protocols and coordinated cross-team readiness.

Manager, Risk and Compliance

11/2019 - 10/2020

Snapdocs

- Reduced organizational risk, improved audit readiness, and accelerated sales cycles to unlock **\$11 million** in revenue by leading trust assurance efforts.
- Developed and implemented a comprehensive GRC program aligned with SOC 2 and ISO 27001, significantly reducing organizational risk in 6 months.
- Enhanced secure-by-design practices by designing a control matrix and implementing FAIR-based risk assessments in the product pipeline.
- Built and implemented a security awareness training program, vetting platforms, curating content, and driving broad adoption.

Lead Senior Security Specialist – Compliance Assurance

02/2019 - 11/2019

Twilio

- Co-led the design and rollout of a Security Compliance Assurance program providing customers with data protection assurance and internal teams with regional compliance guidance and control assessment readiness.
- Created dashboards that visualized control effectiveness and remediation status, enabling data-driven risk mitigation strategies.
- Directed annual penetration test for enterprise email application, defining scope and overseeing remediation, which significantly strengthened application security posture and reduced exploitable vulnerabilities.

Security Compliance Analyst

04/2016 - 02/2019

SendGrid

- Led end-to-end SOC 2 audit readiness across multiple cycles, monitored controls, ran periodic mock audits, and standardized evidence workflows to reduce audit friction and cycle time.
- Supported over **\$1 million** in annual revenue by instilling buyer confidence through security briefings and documentation for enterprise prospects.
- Executed comprehensive disaster recovery drills, improving incident response effectiveness and refining business continuity strategies.
- Owned the enterprise security risk management program, delivered executive reporting that informed security investment and guided risk mitigation strategies.

IT Security Coordinator

07/2014 - 02/2016

Baylor College of Medicine

- Originated the policy and process for managing vulnerabilities for all IT managed systems strengthening organizational security posture to align with HIPAA standards.
- Drove implementation of a Host-based Intrusion Prevention System HIPS that doubled malicious activity detection capabilities across endpoints, elevating real-time threat visibility and response.
- Authored and operationalized an incident response process, improving organizational threat response readiness and awareness.
- Advised executive leadership on a variety of cyber security matters such as strategy, encryption, endpoint protection, cyber security awareness, and vulnerability management.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Information Systems • Indiana University

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

01/2017

ISC2

SKILLS

GRC Engineering, AI Agent Building, Workflow Automation, AI System Governance & Security, Cloud Security, Secure Development, SOC2, ISO27001, Risk Management, Cloud Security Architecture, DevSecOps, Executive Communication, Strategic Planning & Execution, Audit Management